OPENER MAT · KEEP IT ON YOUR TABLE

When, Where, How

Beyond the gate, a narrow path appeared.

Opener, comma, then the rest of the sentence.

When?

TIME OPENER · WRITE T

- At dawn,
- At midnight,
- After school,
- Early that morning,
- Later that night,
- As the sun set,
- Before long,
- After a while,
- Moments later,
- Seconds later,
- Just then,
- At that moment,
- Straight away,
- Without warning,
- For a long moment,
- Within seconds,
- At last,
- All afternoon,

Where?

PLACE OPENER · WRITE P

- Behind the shed,
- Beyond the gate,
- Inside the cave,
- Above her head,
- Beneath the floorboards,
- At the top of the stairs,
- Along the path,
- Across the river,
- Deep in the forest,
- In the distance,
- Somewhere ahead,
- All around her,
- Through the window,
- Next to the door,
- Far below,
- On every side,
- At the end of the hall,
- Under the bridge,

How?

MANNER OPENER · WRITE M

- Slowly,
- Carefully,
- Quietly,
- Gently,
- Bravely,
- Eagerly,
- Without a sound,
- On tiptoe,
- Step by step,
- In a whisper,
- With a gasp,
- With a grin,
- As fast as she could,
- Holding her breath,
- Heart pounding,
- With trembling fingers,
- Squinting,
- Rubbing her eyes,

Link back

POINTS BACK

- Beyond it,
- Behind her,
- Inside,
- At the top,
- Next to it,
- Above them,
- On the other side,
- Even closer,
- Moments later,
- Seconds later,
- Before long,
- After that,

Mix it up. Not every sentence needs an opener. Keep one sentence plain.

Link it back. *Beyond it, Moments later, Behind her,* point back to the sentence before.

Watch out. *Then,* and *Suddenly,* once at most.